

DL

Dustin Lawrence.

FOUNDER, MISSIONCTRL · LONDON · SINCE 2004

Brand strategist who thinks like an activist. Twenty years of brand strategy across five continents and twelve sectors — closing the gap between what an organisation believes, says, and does. The methodology has a name now: **The Brand Effect.**

20

YEARS IN BRAND

5

CONTINENTS

90+

BRANDS SHAPED

11

AWARDS

DIRECT

hello@missionctrl.agency

dl@unicornunited.co

+44 7708 106 853 · London, UK

VIEW THE INTERACTIVE CV →

dustin-lawrence-brand-director.netlify.app

Build a brand **that moves.**

People · Markets · Decisions

Founder, MissionCTRL · Building TrustOS & Unicorn

MOST ORGANISATIONS DON'T HAVE A PURPOSE PROBLEM — THEY HAVE AN ALIGNMENT PROBLEM.

/ 01

Original.

Copies don't move people. Every brand has a truth that hasn't been said the way it deserves — my job is to find it, name it, and hand the team a story they can carry.

Frontline AIDS — repositioned a 25-year INGO as the activist on the front line. Gold Transform Award, 2020.

/ 02

Logical.

Story without structure is just noise. I work in evidence — interviews, audits, data — then translate the mess into a single-minded idea both leadership and the market can stand on.

Baker Tilly — unified 120 firms behind one global brand. 9% growth in year one. Best in a decade.

/ 03

Creative.

The best strategy still has to make someone want to lean in. I guide identity, voice, naming and architecture so the idea doesn't die in the deck — it lives in the room.

Adenza — purpose-led positioning for a fintech merger. Gold Transform Award (twice). Sold to Nasdaq for \$10.5bn.

STRATEGIC CAPABILITY

Brand purpose, positioning & architecture. Strategic narrative. Stakeholder research and insight. M&A and merger integration branding. Brand engagement & activation. Brand measurement.

CREATIVE GUIDANCE

Naming & verbal identity. Voice and tone systems. Visual identity direction. Brand playbooks and guidelines. Campaign and communications planning. Pitch and presentation craft.

SECTORS

Professional services

Financial services

Data & info

Healthcare

Technology

Energy

Industrial

Consumer

NGO

Luxury

Public

Legal



HERO WORK · FOUR BRIEFS THAT SHOW THE RANGE

2018 · BRANDPIE · NGO

JOIN US. END IT.

Frontline AIDS · UK / Global

Repositioned a 25-year-old INGO as the activist on the front line — new name, purpose, voice and identity built to make the world pay attention again.

Gold

Transform · Creative strategy (2020)

Silver

Visual identity, charity

2021 · EMPEROR · FINTECH · M&A

Platform to opportunity.

Adenza — Calypso × AxiomSL

Three-pillar positioning, global research and verbal identity for a digital-first merger brand. Triangle mark followed the strategy.

Gold × 2

Transform · M&A rebrand (2022 + 2023)

\$10.5bn

Sold to Nasdaq, 2023

2017-2018 · BRANDPIE · PROF. SERVICES

Now, for tomorrow.

Baker Tilly International · Global

Unified 120 independent accountancy firms behind a single global brand. Launched across 70+ countries; 130 territories transitioned within a year.

9%

Growth, year one

3 awards

Transform Europe 2020

2006 · HKLM · ENERGY & RESOURCES

Powering possibility.

Exxaro Resources · South Africa

Purpose-led positioning for one of South Africa's largest resources businesses. Still in use nearly two decades on — the work I'm most quietly proud of.

20y

Brand purpose in market

R41.8bn

Group revenue (2025)

CAREER ARC

- 2020 — Now** **MissionCTRL · TrustOS · Unicorn — Founder & fractional brand director**
LONDON · INDEPENDENT
Founded the portfolio — enterprise brand advisory (**MissionCTRL**), trust measurement intelligence (**TrustOS**) and fractional brand partnership (**Unicorn**). Recent: **Saudi Leadership Society** (Misk Foundation), **Geeks**, next-chapter **ICIS** brand plan, **DBX** experience vision, **Solmax** brand tracker, SME-CEO coaching.
- 2021 — 2022** **Emperor Design Consultants — Brand strategy director (contract)**
LONDON
Led strategy on the **Adenza** rebrand (Gold Transform 2022 + 2023; later Nasdaq, \$10.5bn). Global research for Variowell's **Kikoo** & **Swayy** sleeptech. Secured £600k pipeline; thought-leadership writing.
- 2017 — 2019** **BrandPie — Senior strategy consultant**
LONDON
Transformative strategies for **EY**, **Baker Tilly**, **Capgemini**, **ICIS**, **Fastmarkets**, **finnCap**, **PSPA** and **Frontline AIDS**. Pitched and led the Frontline AIDS rebrand.
- 2013 — 2017** **Freelance brand strategist**
LONDON · LANDOR, SIEGEL+GALE, BARINGA, OGILVY HEALTHWORLD, RELUCTANTLY BRAVE, AERON, STRAIGHTLINE, SLAM
Senior contract work across the city's leading consultancies — **Fidelity**, **BP**, **Kaspersky**, **Covestro**, **Barclays**, **Primetals**, **Envigo**, **Emirates Post**, **Lloyds**.
- 2010 — 2012** **Principals — Brand strategist**
SYDNEY
King & Wood Mallesons social and content strategy (highest FB engagement among APAC law firms); **The Coolum Residences** rebrand (REBRAND Award); **WongPartnership** Singapore (REBRAND Award); **JBWere Wealth**.
- 2009 — 2010** **SLAM — Founder & brand strategist**
LONDON & JOHANNESBURG
Boutique consultancy. **The Actuarial Profession** graduate campaign (Digital Impact Award). Freelance digital at **OgilvyOne** Johannesburg.
- 2004 — 2008** **HKLM Group · FIN International — Brand strategist**
JOHANNESBURG & LONDON
Strategy for **University of Johannesburg** (Sunday Times Award), **Singita Game Reserves**, **Design Indaba** 'Capture Freedom' challenge from Wally Olins, and original **Exxaro** 'Powering Possibility'; then **LaSalle Investment Management**.

RECOGNITION · 11 AWARDS

- 2023** **Gold · Transform Europe**
Best M&A rebrand — Adenza (yr 2), Emperor
- 2022** **Gold · Transform Europe**
Best M&A rebrand — Adenza, Emperor
- 2020** **Gold · Transform Europe**
Best creative strategy — Frontline AIDS, BrandPie
- 2020** **Silver · Transform Europe**
Visual identity, NGO — Frontline AIDS, BrandPie
- 2020** **Silver · Transform Europe**
Internal comms — Baker Tilly, BrandPie
- 2020** **Silver · Transform Europe**
Visual identity, prof. services — Baker Tilly, BrandPie
- 2020** **Bronze · Transform Europe**
Brand architecture — Baker Tilly, BrandPie
- 2011** **Digital Impact Award**
The Actuarial Profession graduate campaign
- 2011** **REBRAND 100 Distinction**
The Coolum Residences (ex-Hyatt Coolum), Principals
- 2011** **REBRAND 100 Distinction**
WongPartnership Singapore, Principals
- 2006** **Sunday Times Generation Next**
University of Johannesburg launch, HKLM

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Strategic Communication

University of Johannesburg, 2005

Digital Marketing Certificate, Squared Online · Storytelling for Influence, IDEO U

